

# REAL SOURCE DOCUMENT — MIT ACADEMIC PROCEDURES

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Institution: Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

Topic: Academic Performance and Grades; Term Regulations

Source URL: <https://catalog.mit.edu/mit/procedures/academic-performance-grades/>

Supporting URL: <https://catalog.mit.edu/mit/procedures/term-regulations-exam-policies/>

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## MIT ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE AND GRADING POLICIES

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### GRADING SYSTEM

MIT uses letter grades with the following scale:

A, B, C, D, F — with plus/minus variants (A-, B+, B-, C+, C-, D+, D-)

Grade points: A=5.0, B=4.0, C=3.0, D=2.0, F=0 (MIT uses a 5.0 scale, not 4.0)

Note: MIT's GPA scale goes to 5.0. This differs from the conventional 4.0 scale used at most universities.

### PASS/NO RECORD (P/NR) — FIRST YEAR

All first-semester freshmen at MIT receive Pass/No Record (P/NR) grading. Under P/NR:

- A passing grade (D or above) is recorded as "P" on the transcript
- A failing grade is not recorded at all ("No Record")
- P/NR grades do not affect GPA
- Second-semester freshmen receive A/B/C/No Record grading (ABC/NR): grades of A, B, or C appear; D and F are recorded as "No Record"

### SATISFACTORY/UNSATISFACTORY (S/U) GRADING

Students may elect to take certain subjects on an S/U (Pass/Fail) basis. S/U elections are subject to restrictions per department and subject. Subjects taken on PNR grading cannot be used to meet unit requirements for the MEng program.

### INCOMPLETE GRADES

MIT uses the grade "OX" (formerly "INC") to designate an incomplete. The incomplete must be resolved by a deadline set by the instructor, typically within one semester. Unresolved incompletes become F grades.

### REPEAT POLICY

Students who fail or receive an unsatisfactory grade in a subject may repeat it. The repeated subject and grade appear on the transcript; MIT calculates GPA using all attempts. Unlike some universities, MIT does not replace the prior grade — both grades are counted in GPA computation.

### WITHDRAWAL

Students may drop subjects during the Add/Drop period (approximately the first two weeks of the semester) with no record. After the Add/Drop period, a dropped subject appears as "W" (Withdrawn) on the transcript and does not affect GPA. After the final drop deadline, withdrawal is only possible through a petition process.

## **CREDIT/UNIT LOAD**

Full-time MIT students typically take 48–60 units per semester (equivalent to 4–5 subjects at 12 units each). The normal load is 4 subjects. Students wishing to take more than 60 units in a semester require an overload petition. MIT units: 12 units  $\approx$  3 credit hours in the conventional US semester-hour system.

## **ACADEMIC STANDING**

MIT does not have a formal GPA-based academic probation system equivalent to many universities. Instead, the Academic Performance Group (APG) reviews students who are not making satisfactory progress toward degree completion. Students who accumulate excessive incomplete grades or fail multiple subjects may be placed on a Reduced Program or asked to take a Leave of Absence.

## **PREREQUISITE ENFORCEMENT**

Prerequisites at MIT are listed in the catalog and enforced via the registration system (WebSIS). Students who do not meet listed prerequisites are generally blocked from registration. Instructors may grant permission to override prerequisites via the Permission Number system in WebSIS. Students who complete the prerequisite course concurrently with the downstream course (in cases where the catalog allows a co-requisite structure) may do so only when the catalog explicitly designates the course as a co-requisite.

## **TRANSFER CREDIT**

Transfer credit is evaluated by the relevant department. Students must submit course descriptions and syllabi. Accepted transfer credit is noted on the transcript as "transferred credit" and may satisfy subject requirements. Specific EECS transfer credit questions are handled by the EECS Undergraduate Office.

## **GENERAL INSTITUTE REQUIREMENTS (GIRs) — GRADE REQUIREMENTS**

There is no minimum grade requirement to satisfy a GIR subject — a D is passing and satisfies the requirement. However, departmental program requirements may specify minimum grades. Students should check department-specific requirements in addition to GIR rules.

## **SOURCES:**

- MIT Course Catalog, Academic Procedures — Academic Performance and Grades:  
<https://catalog.mit.edu/mit/procedures/academic-performance-grades/>
- MIT Course Catalog, Academic Procedures — Term Regulations:  
<https://catalog.mit.edu/mit/procedures/term-regulations-exam-policies/>
- MIT EECS Undergraduate Office: <https://www.eecs.mit.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/>